

Department of Economics
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December 17, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Texas A&M University
College Station, TX
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in Macroeconomics in the Department of Economics at Texas A&M University. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to complete my degree in May 2026. My research lies at the intersection of macroeconomics, heterogeneous-agent models, and wealth inequality, with an emphasis on how heterogeneity in returns and income risk shapes aggregate dynamics and policy transmission.

My job market paper estimates a distribution of heterogeneous returns to wealth using micro data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and embeds these estimates into a structural heterogeneous-agent macroeconomic model. I show that persistent return heterogeneity plays a central role in generating observed wealth concentration and has important implications for macroeconomic policy, particularly for the distributional effects of monetary and fiscal interventions. A related project uses longitudinal data from the Health and Retirement Study to study how trust and beliefs interact with portfolio choices and realized returns, providing a behavioral channel linking micro-level heterogeneity to macroeconomic outcomes. Together, these projects form a coherent research agenda focused on distributional macroeconomics, grounded in micro data and quantitative modeling.

Texas A&M's Economics Department is an excellent environment for this work. The department's strengths in macroeconomics, applied microeconomics, and econometrics—along with its emphasis on policy-relevant research—closely match my research interests and training. I am particularly excited by the opportunity to contribute to a large, research-active department with strong graduate and undergraduate programs and to engage with colleagues whose work spans theory, empirical analysis, and public policy. Texas A&M's role as a flagship public research university also aligns well with my interest in research that speaks to broad economic questions with real-world relevance.

Teaching. I have experience teaching and supporting courses in *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, and upper-level electives in macroeconomic policy. My teaching philosophy emphasizes clarity, economic intuition, and the use of data to connect theory to real-world outcomes. At Texas A&M, I would be well prepared to teach undergraduate and graduate macroeconomics, including principles, intermediate macro, and field courses in macroeconomic policy or distributional macroeconomics. I am also eager to contribute to graduate training and to mentor students in empirical and quantitative research.

Beyond academic fit, Texas A&M is an especially attractive institution for me given its strong

academic culture, commitment to excellence in research and teaching, and location within a region that I know well and value highly. I would be enthusiastic about building a long-term academic career at Texas A&M and contributing to the department's mission in research, teaching, and service.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application further.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards